

Psalm 7

Refuge and Righteous Judgment

O Lord my God, in thee do I put my trust
KJV · Standalone study handout

1 • THE WORD (KJV)

- 1 O Lord my God, in thee do I put my trust: save me from all them that persecute me, and deliver me:
- 2 Lest he tear my soul like a lion, rending it in pieces, while there is none to deliver.
- 3 O LORD my God, if I have done this; if there be iniquity in my hands;
- 4 If I have rewarded evil unto him that was at peace with me; (yea, I have delivered him that without cause is mine enemy:)
- 5 Let the enemy persecute my soul, and take it; yea, let him tread down my life upon the earth, and lay mine honour in the dust. Selah.
- 6 Arise, O LORD, in thine anger, lift up thyself because of the rage of mine enemies: and awake for me to the judgment that thou hast commanded.
- 7 So shall the congregation of the people compass thee about: for their sakes therefore return thou on high.
- 8 The LORD shall judge the people: judge me, O LORD, according to my righteousness, and according to mine integrity that is in me.
- 9 Oh let the wickedness of the wicked come to an end; but establish the just: for the righteous God trieth the hearts and reins.
- 10 My defence is of God, which saveth the upright in heart.
- 11 God judgeth the righteous, and God is angry with the wicked every day.
- 12 If he turn not, he will whet his sword; he hath bent his bow, and made it ready.
- 13 He hath also prepared for him the instruments of death; he ordaineth his arrows against the persecutors.
- 14 Behold, he travaileth with iniquity, and hath conceived mischief, and brought forth falsehood.
- 15 He made a pit, and digged it, and is fallen into the ditch which he made.
- 16 His mischief shall return upon his own head, and his violent dealing shall come down upon his own pate.
- 17 I will praise the LORD according to his righteousness: and will sing praise to the name of the LORD most high.

2 • CONTEXT

A shiggaion of David concerning Cush the Benjamite (superscription tradition)—a cry under false accusation. The psalmist takes refuge in God, invites scrutiny of his integrity in the matter, and trusts that evil digs its own pit. Henry emphasizes both the refuge of trust and the moral order in which violence returns on the violent.

3 • VERSE-BY-VERSE COMMENTARY

The notes below cover the whole chapter in one place—read with the KJV text above.

Verse 1-2

Trust and plea for deliverance from persecutors pictured as a tearing lion. Without God, there is no rescuer.

Verse 3-5

Oath of innocence regarding the charge: if he repaid evil for peace, let the enemy win. Integrity is offered to God's judgment, not self-justifying spin.

Verse 6-9

Call for God to arise in judgment for the people's sake. He asks to be judged according to righteousness and integrity in this cause, while longing for wickedness to end and the just to be established—God tries hearts and minds.

Verse 10-13

Defense is of God, who saves the upright. God is a righteous judge, angry with the wicked every day; if they will not turn, sword and bow are ready. Justice is patient yet real.

Verse 14-17

The wicked conceives mischief and falsehood, digs a pit, and falls into it; violence returns on his own head. The psalm ends in praise of the Lord's righteousness.

4 • MEANING & APPLICATION

Meaning.

Under slander, the safe place is God—not revenge. Integrity can be laid before the Judge who tests motives. Evil is self-destructive under God’s government; praise is the fitting end of vindication hope.

Application for life today.

When misrepresented, refuse the lion-fight of self-vindication as first move—put trust in God and keep clean hands. Examine yourself honestly (vv. 3–5) before demanding judgment on others. Trust that pits dug for others often become traps for diggers; leave vengeance to the righteous Judge.

5 • REFLECT & RESPOND

Write your answers in the space below. There are no “right length” answers—honesty before God is the aim.

1. Where are you tempted to self-defend more than to take refuge in God?

2. Is there a charge or conflict where you need verse 3–5 honesty before the Lord?

3. How does believing God “trieth the hearts” free you from managing others’ verdicts?

Name: _____ Date: _____ Group / Church: _____

Sources: King James Version (public domain); Matthew Henry, Commentary on the Whole Bible (themes summarized); Expository themes consistent with MacArthur Study Bible tradition (paraphrased, not quoted). Scripture: King James Version (public domain).